



Case Management Module

Frontend Integration Guide — API Reference & Business Logic

LawERP • Version 1.0 • July 2026

Covers: Cases · Parties · Hearings · Calendar · Timeline · Party Matching

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1. Overview

The Case Management module lets a law firm track legal cases from filing to closure. It supports **Civil** and **Criminal** case types with distinct stage lifecycles, party management, court hearings (tarikh), and a calendar view.

Base URL: `http://localhost:6969/api/v1/firm`

Auth: All endpoints require a valid JWT Bearer token via `Authorization: Bearer <token>`

Roles required: `FIRM_ADMIN`, `ADVOCATE`, or `PARALEGAL`

Request envelope: All POST/PUT requests use `{ "data": { ... } }` wrapper

Module Structure

Package	Purpose
<code>controller/</code>	<code>CaseController</code> , <code>HearingController</code> , <code>CalendarController</code>
<code>service/</code>	<code>CaseService</code> , <code>HearingService</code> , <code>CalendarService</code> , <code>CaseNumberGenerator</code> , <code>PartyMatchService</code>
<code>entity/</code>	<code>Case</code> , <code>CaseParty</code> , <code>Hearing</code> , <code>CaseTimelineEvent</code>
<code>enums/</code>	<code>CaseType</code> , <code>CaseStage</code> , <code>CaseStatus</code> , <code>PartyType</code> , <code>PartyRepresentation</code> , <code>HearingType</code> , <code>HearingStatus</code> , <code>TimelineEventType</code> , <code>BailStatus</code>
<code>repository/</code>	<code>CaseRepository</code> , <code>CasePartyRepository</code> , <code>HearingRepository</code> , <code>CaseTimelineRepository</code>
<code>dto/request/</code>	<code>CreateCaseRequest</code> , <code>UpdateCaseRequest</code> , <code>UpdateCaseStageRequest</code> , <code>AddPartyRequest</code> , <code>LinkPartyRequest</code> , <code>CreateHearingRequest</code> , <code>UpdateHearingRequest</code> , <code>PartyMatchRequest</code>
<code>dto/response/</code>	<code>CaseResponse</code> , <code>PartyResponse</code> , <code>HearingResponse</code> , <code>CalendarEventResponse</code> , <code>TimelineEventResponse</code> , <code>PartyMatchResult</code>

2. Case Number Format

Every case gets a **human-readable case number** instead of a UUID. This is the primary identifier used in all API paths.

Format: `{FIRM_CODE}-{TYPE}-{YEAR}-{SEQUENCE}`

Example: `APX-CIV-2026-00001`
`APX-CRM-2026-00042`

APX

CIV

2026

00001

Firm code

Type

Year

5-digit zero-padded
(CIV/CRM) sequence (starts at 1)

Part	Source	Example
FIRM_CODE	Law firm code (set at firm creation)	APX
TYPE	CIV for Civil, CRM for Criminal	CIV
YEAR	Current year (server time)	2026
SEQUENCE	Auto-incremented per firm+type+year	00001

Important: All {caseNumber} path parameters in the API use this format. The frontend should display this as the primary case identifier, not the internal UUID.

3. Case Types & Lifecycle

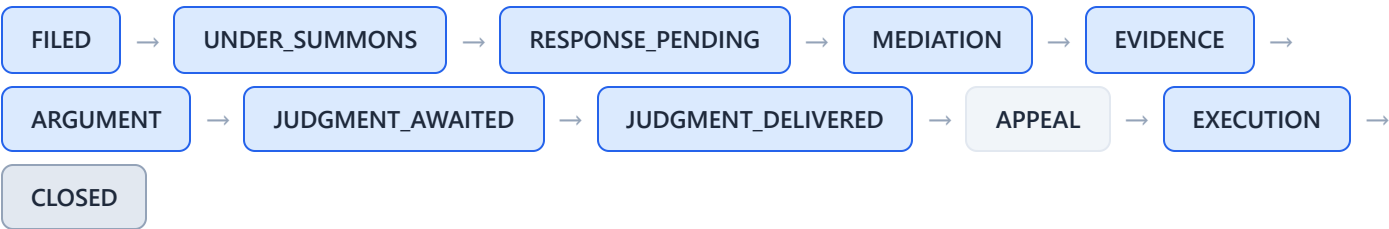
3.1 Case Types

Case Type	Code	Initial Stage
Civil	CIVIL	FILED
Criminal	CRIMINAL	FIR_REGISTERED

3.2 Case Statuses

Status	Meaning
ACTIVE	Case is open and being worked on (default on creation)
CLOSED	Case has reached the CLOSED stage (terminal)
ARCHIVED	Case is archived (future use)

3.3 Stage Lifecycle — Civil



Any civil stage can transition directly to **CLOSED**. After **JUDGMENT_DELIVERED**, possible transitions are **APPEAL**, **EXECUTION**, or **CLOSED**.

3.4 Stage Lifecycle — Criminal





Any criminal stage can transition directly to CLOSED. After JUDGMENT_DELIVERED, possible transitions are APPEAL, SENTENCING, OR CLOSED.

⚠ Validation: The server enforces **valid stage transitions**. If the frontend attempts an invalid transition (e.g. FILED → TRIAL), the API returns a 400 error describing the constraint. The frontend should populate stage dropdowns using the current stage's allowed transitions.

3.5 Civil Case Fields

Field	Type	Notes
mediationDate	LocalDate	Date of mediation hearing
mediationOutcome	String	Result of mediation (settled, failed, etc.)
writtenStatementDeadline	LocalDate	Deadline for filing written statements

3.6 Criminal Case Fields

Field	Type	Notes
firNumber	String	First Information Report number
firDate	LocalDate	Date FIR was registered
policeStation	String	Police station that registered the FIR
investigationAuthority	String	Investigating officer or agency
arrestDate	LocalDate	Date of arrest (if applicable)
chargeSheetDate	LocalDate	Date charge sheet was filed
bailStatus	BailStatus (GRANTED / DENIED / PENDING)	Current bail status

4. Parties

Parties are the people or entities involved in a case — plaintiffs, defendants, accused, etc. Each party can optionally be **linked** to an existing **client profile** in the firm's CRM.

4.1 Party Types

Party Type	Code	Typical Use
Plaintiff	PLAINTIFF	Person who brings the case (Civil)
Defendant	DEFENDANT	Person being sued (Civil)
Accused	ACCUSED	Person charged (Criminal)
Appellant	APPELLANT	Person filing an appeal
Respondent	RESPONDENT	Party responding to an appeal
Applicant	APPLICANT	Person making an application

4.2 Party Representation

Representation	Meaning
REPRESENTED	Represented by our firm (default for plaintiffs)
OPPOSING	Represented by opposing counsel (default for defendants)
SELF	Self-represented (pro se)

4.3 Linking Parties to Clients

When a party is linked to a client profile via `PUT /{caseNumber}/parties/{partyId}/link`, the party record gets a `clientId` reference. This enables cross-referencing:

- See all cases a client is involved in
- Deduplicate party entries across cases
- Access client communication history from the case view

5. Party Matching (Dedup)

Before adding a party, the frontend can call the **match API** to check if the person already exists in the system — either as a client profile or as a party in another case. This prevents duplicate entries.

5.1 Confidence Levels

Level	Criteria
HIGH	Exact name match AND phone/email match
MEDIUM	Exact name match alone, or partial name + phone/email, or phone/email alone
LOW	Partial name match only

Frontend suggestion: When creating a case with parties, call `POST /parties/match` for each party before submission. If HIGH matches are found, pre-link them automatically. If MEDIUM matches are found, show a suggestion in the UI. If LOW, ignore.

6. Hearings (Court Dates / Tarikh)

Hearings track court appearances. Each hearing is linked to a case via `caseNumber`. Hearings have **conflict detection** — if an advocate already has a hearing at the same time, the API returns a 409 error.

6.1 Hearing Types

Type	Purpose
FIRST_HEARING	Initial court appearance
PLEA	Plea hearing (criminal)
EVIDENCE	Evidence presentation
ARGUMENT	Final arguments
JUDGMENT	Judgment delivery
STATUS_CONF	Status conference
OTHER	Other / miscellaneous

6.2 Hearing Statuses

Status	Meaning
SCHEDULED	Hearing is planned (default on creation)
HELD	Hearing took place. An <code>outcome</code> can be recorded.
ADJOURNED	Hearing was postponed to a future date
CANCELED	Hearing was cancelled

⚠ Status changes trigger timeline events:

- SCHEDULED → HELD → Timeline event: "Hearing held: {title}"
- SCHEDULED → ADJOURNED → Timeline event: "Hearing adjourned: {title}"
- Cancelling via DELETE /hearings/{id} → Status set to CANCELED

6.3 Conflict Detection

When scheduling or updating a hearing, if both `time`, `endTime`, and `advocateId` are provided, the server checks for overlapping hearings. A conflict exists if:

- The same advocate has a SCHEDULED hearing on the same date, and
- The time ranges overlap (existing start $\leq$ new end AND existing end $\geq$ new start)

7. Calendar

The calendar is a **read-only view** over hearings. It returns hearings enriched with case details (caseNumber, caseTitle) for display in a calendar UI.

7.1 Calendar Endpoints

Endpoint	Description
GET /calendar?from=...&to=...	Hearings in a date range
GET /calendar/today	Today's hearings
GET /calendar/upcoming?days=N	Next N days (default 7)

All calendar endpoints accept an optional `advocateId` query param to filter by advocate.

8. Timeline

Every case has an event timeline — a chronological log of significant actions. Timeline events are **auto-generated** by the server. The frontend cannot create events directly.

8.1 Timeline Event Types

Event Type	Triggered When
CASE_CREATED	Case is created
STAGE_CHANGE	Stage is updated via <code>PUT /{caseNumber}/stage</code>
HEARING_SCHEDULED	Hearing is created
HEARING_HELD	Hearing status changes to HELD
HEARING_ADJOURNED	Hearing status changes to ADJOURNED
PARTY_ADDED	Party is added to the case
CASE_NOTE_ADDED	Case details are updated

Frontend: The timeline is displayed via `GET /{caseNumber}/timeline`. The response is ordered newest-first. Display as a vertical feed with icons per event type.

9. Audit Logging

All significant operations in the Case Management module are logged to the audit system. These logs are queryable via the existing Audit API: `GET /api/v1/firm/audit/logs`.

9.1 Case Management Audit Events

Audit Action	Entity	When
CASE_CREATED	CASE	New case created
CASE_UPDATED	CASE	Case details or parties updated
CASE_DELETED	CASE	Case deleted (no active hearings required)
CASE_STATUS_CHANGED	CASE	Stage transition
HEARING_SCHEDULED	HEARING	New hearing scheduled
HEARING_UPDATED	HEARING	Hearing details changed
HEARING_CANCELLED	HEARING	Hearing cancelled

10. Permissions & Roles

All Case Management endpoints require at least one of these roles:

Role	Access Level
FIRM_ADMIN	Full access — all cases, all operations, calendar for all advocates
ADVOCATE	Can view/edit assigned cases, schedule hearings (with conflict detection), calendar filtered by self
PARALEGAL	Can view and update case details, manage documents, view calendar

11. Error Codes

HTTP Status	Error Message	When
400	Cannot transition from 'X' to 'Y'	Invalid stage transition
400	Cannot change stage of a closed case	Trying to update a CLOSED case's stage
400	Stage 'X' is not valid for case type 'Y'	Using a criminal stage on a civil case
400	Cannot delete case with active hearings	Case has non-cancelled hearings
400	Advocate has a scheduling conflict	Overlapping hearing time for the same advocate
404	Case not found: {caseNumber}	Invalid case number
404	Party not found with id: {id}	Invalid party UUID
404	Hearing not found: {id}	Invalid hearing UUID
403	Party does not belong to this case or firm	Cross-firm party access
403	Firm context required	No firm context in token
409	A record with this data already exists	Duplicate role-permission (for RBAC, not case)

12. Complete API Reference

12.1 Cases

POST /cases

Create a new case. Automatically generates caseNumber. Optionally add plaintiffs and defendants.

Request Body

```
{
  "data": {
    // Required
    "caseType": "CIVIL" | "CRIMINAL",
    "title": "Divorce Petition - Sharma v. Sharma",

    // Common fields (optional)
    "courtName": "District Court, Kathmandu",
    "courtCaseNumber": "CV-2026-042",
    "filingDate": "2026-07-15",
    "filingNumber": "F-2026-891",
    "assignedTo": "uuid-of-advocate",
    "description": "Property dispute between two parties",

    // Civil fields (only for CIVIL)
    "mediationDate": "2026-08-15",
    "mediationOutcome": "Settled partially",
    "writtenStatementDeadline": "2026-09-01",

    // Criminal fields (only for CRIMINAL)
    "firNumber": "FIR-042-2026",
    "firDate": "2026-07-10",
    "policeStation": "Hanuman Dhoka",
    "investigationAuthority": "CIB",
    "arrestDate": "2026-07-11",
    "chargeSheetDate": "2026-07-20",
    "bailStatus": "PENDING",

    // Parties (optional)
    "plaintiffs": [
      {
        "fullName": "Rajesh Sharma",
        "mobileNo": "9801234567",
        "email": "rajesh@email.com",
        "address": "Kathmandu",
        "representation": "REPRESENTED",
        "clientId": "uuid-of-client",
      }
    ]
  }
}
```

```
    "isOurClient": true,
    "advocateId": "uuid-of-advocate",
    "notes": "Main plaintiff"
  }
],
"defendants": [
  {
    "fullName": "Sita Sharma",
    "mobileNo": "9809876543"
  }
]
}
```

Key Response Fields

Field	Type	Note
caseNumber	String	e.g. APX-CIV-2026-00001 — use this for all subsequent API calls
caseStage	String	Initial stage: FILED or FIR_REGISTERED
status	String	Always ACTIVE on creation
parties	Array	List of PartyResponse objects
hearingCount	Number	Count of non-cancelled hearings

GET

/cases?caseType=CIVIL&page=0&size=20

Paginated case list with optional filters.

Query Parameters

Param	Type	Required
caseType	CIVIL CRIMINAL	No
caseStage	One of the stage enum values	No
status	ACTIVE CLOSED ARCHIVED	No
assignedTo	UUID	No
courtName	String (fuzzy search)	No
dateFrom	ISO date (2026-01-01)	No
dateTo	ISO date	No
search	String (matches title, caseNumber, filingNumber)	No
page	int (0-based)	Default: 0
size	int	Default: 20

GET

/cases/{caseNumber}

Get full case details including parties and hearing count.

{caseNumber} is the human-readable format, e.g. APX-CIV-2026-00001

PUT `/cases/{caseNumber}`

Update case details. All fields are optional — only send the fields being updated.

Cannot update `caseType`, `caseStage`, or `status` via this endpoint. Use the stage endpoint instead.

DELETE `/cases/{caseNumber}`

Delete a case. **Fails (400) if the case has any non-cancelled hearings.**

Cancel hearings first via `DELETE /hearings/{hearingId}` before deleting the case.

PUT `/cases/{caseNumber}/stage`

Transition case to the next stage. Server validates the transition rules.

Request Body

```
{
  "data": {
    "stage": "UNDER_SUMMONS"
  }
}
```

GET `/cases/{caseNumber}/timeline`

Get all timeline events for a case, newest-first.

12.2 Parties

POST /cases/{caseNumber}/parties

Add a party to an existing case.

```
{
  "data": {
    "partyType": "PLAINTIFF",
    "fullName": "Rajesh Sharma",
    "mobileNo": "9801234567",
    "email": "rajesh@email.com",
    "address": "Kathmandu",
    "representation": "REPRESENTED",
    "clientId": "uuid",
    "isOurClient": true,
    "advocateId": "uuid",
    "notes": "Primary contact"
  }
}
```

PUT /cases/{caseNumber}/parties/{partyId}

Update a party's details. Internally does remove+add — sends back the new party record.

PUT /cases/{caseNumber}/parties/{partyId}/link

Link a party to an existing client profile for cross-referencing.

```
{
  "data": {
    "clientId": "uuid-of-client-profile",
    "isOurClient": true
  }
}
```

DELETE `/cases/{caseNumber}/parties/{partyId}`

Remove a party from the case.

12.3 Party Matching

POST /cases/parties/match

Match a person against existing client profiles and case parties in this firm.

```
{
  "data": {
    "fullName": "Rajesh Sharma",
    "mobileNo": "9801234567",
    "email": "rajesh@email.com"
  }
}
```

Response

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": [
    {
      "sourceType": "CLIENT",
      "sourceId": "uuid",
      "fullName": "Rajesh Sharma",
      "mobileNo": "9801234567",
      "email": "rajesh@email.com",
      "confidence": "HIGH"
    },
    {
      "sourceType": "CASE_PARTY",
      "sourceId": "uuid",
      "fullName": "Raj S.",
      "confidence": "LOW"
    }
  ]
}
```

12.4 Hearings

POST /cases/{caseNumber}/hearings

Schedule a hearing with automatic conflict detection.

```
{
  "data": {
    "title": "First Hearing",
    "date": "2026-08-01",
    "time": "10:00:00",
    "endTime": "11:00:00",
    "courtRoom": "Court Room 3",
    "judgeName": "Hon. Judge Pandey",
    "hearingType": "FIRST_HEARING",
    "notes": "Initial appearance",
    "attendees": "Rajesh Sharma, Sita Sharma",
    "advocateId": "uuid-of-advocate"
  }
}
```

GET /cases/{caseNumber}/hearings

List all hearings for a case, newest-first.

GET /hearings/{hearingId}

Get a single hearing's details. Uses hearingId (UUID), not caseNumber.

PUT /hearings/{hearingId}

Update hearing details. Can change status to HELD, ADJOURNED, etc.

DELETE `/hearings/{hearingId}`

Cancel a hearing (sets status to CANCELED).

12.5 Calendar

GET `/calendar?from=2026-08-01&to=2026-08-07`

Get hearings in a date range. Both from and to are required.

Optional: `?advocateId=uuid` to filter by advocate.

GET `/calendar/today`

All hearings scheduled for today.

GET `/calendar/upcoming?days=7`

Upcoming hearings in the next N days (default 7). Returns only SCHEDULED hearings.

13. Example Flows

Flow A: Create a Civil Case with Parties → Add Hearing → Update Stage

1. POST `/cases` — Create case with plaintiffs + defendants. Save `caseNumber`.
2. POST `/cases/{caseNumber}/hearings` — Schedule first hearing (conflict detection runs automatically).
3. POST `/cases/{caseNumber}/hearings` — Schedule another hearing.
4. PUT `/hearings/{hearingId}` — Mark hearing as HELD with outcome.
5. PUT `/cases/{caseNumber}/stage` — Transition to next stage: `UNDER_SUMMONS`.
6. GET `/cases/{caseNumber}/timeline` — See all events: case created, hearing scheduled, hearing held, stage changed.

Flow B: Check for Duplicate Parties Before Creating a Case

1. User types party name/phone in the form.
2. Frontend calls POST `/cases/parties/match` with the entered details.
3. If `HIGH` confidence: auto-link party to client profile, show linked badge.
4. If `MEDIUM` confidence: show suggestion "This person might already exist in another case".
5. If `LOW` or no matches: proceed with new party entry.
6. Submit case creation via POST `/cases` with `clientId` pre-filled for matched parties.

Flow C: Full Case Lifecycle (Criminal)

1. POST `/cases` — `caseType`: "CRIMINAL", include FIR details. Initial stage: `FIR_REGISTERED`.
2. PUT `/cases/{caseNumber}/stage` — `UNDER_INVESTIGATION`.
3. PUT `/cases/{caseNumber}` — Update with investigation updates.
4. POST `/cases/{caseNumber}/hearings` — Schedule plea hearing.
5. PUT `/cases/{caseNumber}/stage` — `CHARGE_SHEET_FILED` → `PLEA` → `TRIAL`.
6. PUT `/hearings/{hearingId}` — Mark hearings as HELD with outcomes.
7. GET `/cases/{caseNumber}/timeline` — Full audit trail of the case.

Flow D: Delete a Case (Requires Cancelling All Hearings First)

1. GET `/cases/{caseNumber}/hearings` — Check existing hearings.
2. For each scheduled hearing: DELETE `/hearings/{hearingId}`.
3. DELETE `/cases/{caseNumber}` — Now succeeds.

⚠ Important: If the frontend sends an invalid stage transition (e.g. attempting to go directly from FILED to TRIAL), the API returns **400** with a message describing the constraint. This is intentional — the frontend should show the allowed transitions from the current stage rather than guessing.

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